

CSE 3000

Fall 2026

Contemporary Issues in Computer Science & Engineering

Instructor: Matt Lamoureux**Instructor email:** matthew.lamoureux@uconn.edu**Office:** E2 300**Office Hours:** MWF 10-11, or by appointment.

Text: *Do Androids Dream of Electric Sheep?* by Philip K. Dick, and *Ethical Machines: Your Concise Guide to Unbiased, Transparent, and Respectful AI*, by Reid Blackman.

Supplies: Access to Python and Jupyter Notebooks.

Prerequisites: CSE 3140 (Cybersecurity Lab).

Learning Outcomes:

1. Analyze contemporary issues in computing within global and societal contexts.
2. Evaluate the ethical responsibilities of computing professionals.
3. Discuss the impact of technology on privacy, security, equity, and sustainability.
4. Communicate informed perspectives on policy, governance, and social implications of emerging technologies.

Alignment to Career Readiness Competencies: See www.nacweb.org for more detail.

1. *Teamwork:* Review a paper with peers and report on findings.
2. *Communication:* Present effectively to both technical and non-technical audiences.
3. *Critical Thinking:* Submit written responses and coding solutions related to various real-world scenarios.
4. *Equity & Inclusion:* Discuss the ethical considerations in computing.
5. *Technology:* Leverage Github to share project work effectively.

Academic Integrity:

Integrity is a crucial part of the academic experience. You must observe the University's Academic Integrity Policy as found in the Student Code. Cheating can result in one or more of the following: a score of zero on the assignment; a grade of F in the course; expulsion from the university and/or any subsidiary programs.

Summary of Grades:

Participation	In class	25%
Homework	Submitted in HuskyCT & Gradescope	50%
Final Project Presentation	Last 3 weeks of class	25%

Participation:

- Because this is a discussion-based course, attendance in lectures will be critical to achieving learning outcomes. Asking and responding to questions in class is expected.
- We will sometimes use Slido polls in class, and credit will be given on HuskyCT.
- Everyone starts with 1 free credit!
- You can miss a poll without penalty, **if you don't email me requesting exception(s)**. If you request an exception, you will see your free credit removed from HuskyCT.
- If you attempt to remotely submit an answer to a Slido poll without being in class, you will be given a 0 for the entire participation portion of your grade.

Homework:

- There will be weekly assignments that must be submitted via the links in HuskyCT.
- I am happy to help! Feel free to attend office hours or reach out with questions.
- Deadlines will be available on HuskyCT and generally at midnight. Start each assignment early and submit what is completed by the deadline.
- Everyone starts with 1 free credit!
- You can miss a homework assignment without penalty, **if you don't email me requesting exception(s)**. If you request an exception, you will see your free credit removed from HuskyCT.

Final Project:

- You will collaborate in groups of 3 to present on the findings of a paper of your choice. The topic of the paper must come from a scholarly journal and be relevant to a contemporary issue in computer science.
- Once groups are finalized, you will submit a copy of your chosen paper on HuskyCT.
- Presentations must be delivered in person during the last three weeks of classes. More information will be provided on HuskyCT.